Let the games begin!

At Times Network, we take a lot of pride in everything we do. Over the past two years, ever since Digit became a part of the Times family, we have not only grown but continually evolved to deliver new experiences, sharper testing, and deeper tech insights to our users alike.

Beyond traditional media forms, our journey has been defined by creating experiential, high-impact IPs that resonate directly with consumer passion points. From honoring innovation with the Digit Zero1 Awards and elevating home technology through Digit India's Top Appliance Awards (DITAA), to thought-leadership platforms like Data Leadership, cutting-edge ecosystem forums such as Snapdragon Auto Day, upskilling initiatives like Digit Masterclass, and immersive technology showcases like Zoom Into Reality, our flagship IPs have set industry benchmarks.

However, the next cycle of our growth isn't just about crafting great experiences. It revolves around putting these experiences directly into the hands of more and more people across the country.

Which brings me to one of our most exciting initiatives yet.

I couldn't be happier to announce the SKOAR! Dominator Cup 2026.

Building on SKOAR!'s rich legacy as a pioneer in the Indian esports and gaming space, this massive six-month-long tournament is designed to take competitive gaming to grassroots collegiate hubs across India. Spanning over 100 colleges and bringing together more than 75,000 gamers, the SKOAR! Dominator Cup 2026 is built to redefine student-level esports engagement in the country.

India boasts over 500 million active gamers, trailing only China globally. With over 100 million daily active users, interactive gaming has become the primary leisure choice for India's youth demographic.

The rise of gaming in India is driven by affordable 5G networks and accessible hardware. Mobile platforms command nearly 80% of India's gaming market share. Over 84% of players engage via Android and iOS devices. Over 50% of Indian gamers are under the age of 30, with the 15–24 age bracket accounting for over 40% of overall engagement and gaming activity. Furthermore, female gamers now represent 44% of the total gaming population, underscoring an increasingly diverse player ecosystem.



"By taking the competition directly into 100 colleges over six action-packed months, we are building a national stage for student athletes."

Manas Tiwari
Editor

In India, gaming is no longer confined to high-end PCs. It lives on accessible smartphones in Tier-1, Tier-2, and Tier-3 cities alike, serving as a social network, a competitive arena, and a burgeoning career pathway for young talent.

Yet, despite this massive user base, structured pathways for aspiring student gamers remain limited. Most grassroot players lack formal platforms to showcase their talent.

That is precisely where the SKOAR! Dominator Cup 2026 steps in.

By taking the competition directly into 100 colleges over six action-packed months, we are building a national stage for student athletes. It's an avenue to discover the next generation of professional esports athletes, shoutcasters, content creators, and community leaders right from campus corridors.

Integrating Digit's deep media heritage with SKOAR!'s gaming pedigree allows us to deliver an unprecedented ecosystem. The participants will also engage with top-tier gaming hardware, interact with industry leaders and experience firsthand what makes modern competitive gaming a professional pursuit.

As Times Network continues to push boundaries across tech, media, and IP creation, the SKOAR! Dominator Cup 2026 marks the beginning of a vibrant new chapter — one where community, competition, and technology converge seamlessly.

To every student gamer across the nation refining their aim, building their squads, and waiting for their moment: the stage is set.

Want to share your thoughts, write to : **editor@digit.in**